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(AI-Generated Session Notes)

A Beginner's Guide to Vibe Coding: Build for Your Business. Think Like an Engineer.

Date & time: Oct. 14, 3:05-3:40 PM EST
Track: Applied AI



Vinny Sosa

Lead Marketing AI Solutions Architect, ServiceTitan

- LinkedIn

Session Description

"Vibe Coding" — writing software using natural language and AI rather than syntax — is the biggest opportunity for marketers and knowledge workers in 2026. Most people start the same way: copy-pasting code from a chatbot, feeling unstoppable, then hitting a wall. That is not the wrong way to start. That is just the beginning.

The marketers building real, secure, production-ready tools have moved through that stage and into something harder to name: part developer, part architect, entirely non-engineer. They are everyday inventors.

In this session, Vinny Sosa will walk attendees through his journey from chatbot curiosity to deploying tools they would be proud to show their CISO, without a CS degree. Attendees will leave with practical build guidance, a private-by-default GitHub habit, a clear picture of where they are in the five levels of AI mastery, and where to go next. They do not need to be engineers to vibe code meaningful applications. But they do need to think like one.

Key Quote

> *"I was using the power of AI to try to go around the development process instead of to learn the development process."* **- Vinny Sosa**

Session Summary

Vinny Sosa, Lead Marketing AI Solutions Architect at ServiceTitan, brings 16 years of marketing technology and operations experience to this session. After years of solving problems without being able to build the solutions himself, he stepped down from a director role to work hands-on with AI. His first major project was Marketing Mind, a system that ingests the marketing team's webinars, customer stories, blog posts, and other content so it can be searched and reactivated across channels.

Sosa was candid that the journey was messy. For about two months he copied and pasted code from Gemini into files and ran them on his desktop, rebuilding the application twice as the AI lost context. The night before a promised demo to his CMO, he added one more feature without

using GitHub and broke everything. Switching to VS Code exposed him to the development process he had been avoiding, and he rebuilt three months of work in three hours. He also warned about burnout, noting that working with AI is not only about being faster but about building discipline and quality.

He framed the path using Peter Yang's AI adoption ladder, from search and productivity partner to prototyping, full engineering, and agentic development, and matched tools to each level, such as Google AI Studio for prototyping and IDEs like Cursor, VS Code, or Claude Code for level four and beyond. A central distinction: vibe coding on your own computer is low-stakes, but once an app is hosted for others, you are in systems engineering and must think about security, performance, uptime, reliability, and authentication.

The core of the talk was a series of lessons for building responsibly: consider free options like Google Apps Script or GitHub Pages before cloud infrastructure, spend most of your time on requirements, assume the handoff to a developer, use scripted tests, keep repos private and secrets out of your project, track work with versioning notes and architectural decision records, keep files small, pin dependencies, use infrastructure as code, separate prod and staging, own security, automate checks on commits, and make the security team a partner.

Marketing Mind now handles about 1,500 user searches a month, plus heavy use through MCP servers in Claude and ChatGPT, and lets sales BDRs find and repurpose content in under 30 seconds. Sosa closed by saying you don't need to be a developer to vibe code, but you do need to think like one, adding that developers aren't going anywhere.

Key Takeaways

- **Learn the process, don't route around it.** Using AI to bypass the development process cost Sosa months and two rebuilds, while moving to an IDE let him rebuild three months of work in three hours.
- **Know where to stop.** Vibe coding a personal utility is low-stakes, but deploying for others means owning security, performance, uptime, and authentication, so stay local if you don't want that responsibility.
- **Plan before you build.** Spending about 80% of your time on detailed requirements lets agents build in one pass and avoids burning tokens on rework.
- **Assume the handoff.** Build as if a developer will take over in three months, which drives habits like scripted tests, versioning notes, decision records, pinned dependencies, and separate prod and staging environments.
- **Private by default, security as a partner.** Create a private repo before you start coding, keep secrets out of your project, and work transparently with your security team instead of around them.